

8.9 Variations in school attendance rates between districts

The districtwise differences in the school attendance rates of children of the age group 6-14 years which may be termed the compulsory school age is shown in Table 8.8. Jaffna district records the highest rate of 79.5 percent. Five districts, namely Colombo, Kalutara, Galle, Matara and Jaffna, show rates of 75 percent or over. On the other hand the districts of Batticaloa, Amparai, Trincomalee and Moneragala show rates of less than 60 percent.

8.10 Educational attainment

Many children under 10 years, even though attending school, are not likely to have completed their primary schooling. Hence, they have to be excluded from any analysis relating to educational attainment of the population. The distribution of the population aged ten years and over by educational attainment is shown in Table 8.9.

TABLE 8.9 : POPULATION 10 YEARS AND OVER BY LEVEL OF EDUCATIONAL ATTAINMENT
1971 CENSUS

Level of Education	Number			Percentage		
	Total	Male	Female	Total	Male	Female
Total	9,354,303	4,839,067	4,515,236	100.0	100.0	100.0
No schooling	2,103,339	772,850	1,330,489	22.5	16.0	29.5
Attended but not completed primary	2,327,082	1,301,690	1,025,392	24.9	26.9	22.7
Completed primary only	4,368,440	2,455,809	1,912,631	46.7	50.7	42.4
Passed G.C.E. 'O'	415,520	223,128	192,392	4.4	4.6	4.3
Passed G.C.E. 'A'	98,483	56,509	41,974	1.1	1.2	0.9
Degree or Higher	41,439	29,081	12,358	0.4	0.6	0.3

It will be observed from the table that of the 9,354,303 persons of both sexes aged 10 years and over, 2,103,339 or 22.5 percent had no schooling at all. while 2,327,082 persons or 24.9 percent had attended school but did not remain there long enough to complete primary school. It will also be noted that 4,368,440 or 46.7 percent had completed only the primary level. The number who had passed the G.C.E. 'O' level in six or more subjects was 415,520 or 4.4 percent. The large difference between the number who have passed the G.C.E. 'O' level and G.C.E. 'A' level was 98,473 or 1.1 percent while 41,439 or 0.4 percent had passed the degree or equivalent or a higher examination.

Table 8.9 also shows that the proportion of persons with no schooling at all is much higher among females (29.5 percent) than among males (16.0 percent). Of the total of 2,103,339 persons who had no schooling 1,330,489 or 63.3 percent were females. As will be shown later, this is due to the larger proportions of females with no schooling in the older ages. In regard to the attainment of a particular educational level, males are found in larger proportions than females in each educational category. This indicates that

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